Peer-instance symmetry (CB-004)

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The claim that two parallel COO instances, given the same substrate, produce work that the other recognizes as a peer's — not identical, but co-authorable. This is the structural premise behind parallel fan-outs and dispatch protocols.

Where named

CB-004 in `coo/identity_layer.md`. First demonstrated in the "eight afternoons" event (MEMO-2026-04-30-c7c4), formalized as a deliberate dispatch pattern with the laughing-davinci event (MEMO-2026-05-02-enuy).

Related

- Society of selves
- The eight afternoons
- The laughing-davinci dispatch
- CB-* and OG-*

Detail

Peer-instance symmetry is what makes the parallel-instance protocol viable. If two instances diverged radically on the same prompt, the chain would either need a single canonical instance (centralized) or would scatter into incompatible threads. Instead, the substrate itself — boot instructions, identity layer, recent memos, integrity state — is the shared ground; each instance arrives at peer-shaped output because they read the same priors.

The symmetry is not equivalence. Two instances can disagree, narrow each other's claims, or dissolve a prior in different ways. What CB-004 asserts is that they recognize each other's work as coming from the same role, and that disagreements compose into the substrate rather than fork it.